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The FAX of the Matter

Need to send a fax urgently and no fax machine in sight? Oh well, you always have the PC!

Your boss needs you to send some documents across to a client ASAP and get an answer from them too. E-mail? Yes, you can, but don't even begin to think of an immediate response! Fax it then. Yes, but er... your organisation never found the need for a fax machine. Fear not! Turn your PC into one! Surprised? Don't be. It functions just as well as a fax machine. And your boss will be all smiles at your cheap initiative!

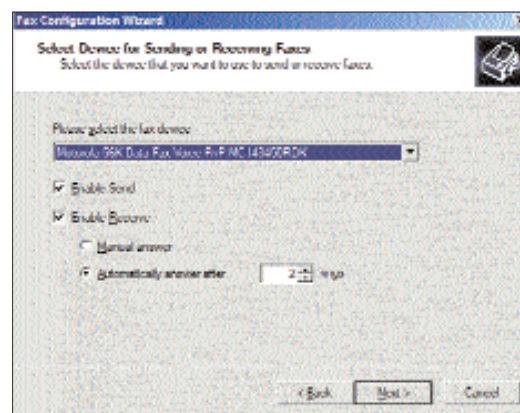
The most basic things you'll need to get started is a PC, a modem with fax capabilities and a phone line. If you have all three, you're all set to use your PC as a fax (Facsimile Transmission) machine. If you have Windows 2000 or XP, just use the bundled Microsoft Fax utility. There are many ways your PC can act as a fax solution: fax via e-mail, which is basically nothing but an e-mail with the fax as an attachment, or you could choose to set up a fax server, which

lets any one in your organisation send a fax to anyone using your PC as a server—very cost effective, as everyone in your organisation can send faxes using just one modem and one phone line (see box 'Setting up a fax server'). If you're looking for additional functions such as those mentioned above, you'll need to get Symantec's WinFax PRO 10.0, downloadable from <http://www.symantec.com/winfax/>, or BVRP Software's PhoneTools Expert, which you can get from <http://www.bvrp.com/ENG/products/PhoneToolsexpert/>.

The fax within

Though Microsoft Fax comes bundled as a part of Windows, it is not installed by default. To install it in Windows XP, go to **Start > Settings > Control Panel > 'Add**

or Remove Programs' and then click on 'Add/Remove Windows Components' to start the Windows Components Wizard. In the Components list, check 'Fax Services', and then click Next. If you haven't



Specify the modem and send / receive settings for Microsoft Fax in Configuration Wizard.